

# Personal Money Planner

A complete guide to every feature

Everything stays on your phone. The app has no internet permission at all, so nothing you record can leave the device.

# What is in this guide

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## 1. How the app thinks about money

Four rules decide every figure in the app. They are worth two minutes, because once you know them nothing the app shows you will look surprising.

### **Your balance is never stored, it is rebuilt**

The app does not keep a running total that it edits. Every time it needs your balance it adds up your opening balances and every movement you have recorded since. Correct a mistake you made three months ago and today's balance fixes itself, with no repair step and nothing left disagreeing.

### **A card purchase is not cash leaving**

Buying something on a credit card does not reduce your bank balance that day. It raises what you owe on the card. The money actually leaves when you pay the card bill, and that is when the app counts it. Counting both would subtract the same rupee twice.

### **Every commitment is counted once**

When you mark a bill as paid, the app writes the expense for you and links it to that bill. The forecast then stops expecting that month's payment, and your everyday spending average ignores it. Rent can never show up both as a scheduled bill and as ordinary spending.

### **Nothing is guessed**

Every projected figure traces back to something you entered: a salary, a loan, a bill, or your own spending history. The app does not assume what people generally spend. Where it does not have enough history to answer, it says so instead of inventing a number.

#### **Amounts are exact**

Money is held as a whole number of paise, never as a decimal that can drift. A bill split three ways gives 33.34 / 33.33 / 33.33 and the parts always add back to the total, to the paisa.

## 2. Setting up

First run walks you through the essentials. Everything is optional and everything can be changed later, so put in what you know and move on.

### **What setup asks for**

|                           |                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Your name</b>          | Only used to greet you on the dashboard.                                                                                                    |
| <b>Your balance today</b> | The single most useful thing to get right. Everything else is measured from it.                                                             |
| <b>Your salary</b>        | Amount and the day it usually arrives. This becomes a recurring income source, so the forecast knows when money is due.                     |
| <b>Rent or a big bill</b> | Optional, but one recurring bill makes the first forecast far more useful.                                                                  |
| <b>An EMI</b>             | Optional. If a loan is already part-way through, say how many installments you have already paid and the remaining tenure works itself out. |

#### Correcting your balance later

Settings → Your balance lets you state what you actually have. The app does not rewrite your history: it records the difference as a visible correction, so the number still explains itself afterwards.

### Add your accounts early

Go to **More** → **Accounts** and add each bank account, your cash in hand, and any wallet you use. Give each one the balance it held on a date you can remember. From then on you can see not just how much you have, but where it is. Section 6 covers this in full.

## 3. The dashboard

The home screen answers the questions people actually open the app for: what have I got, what is coming, and will I be alright.

### Available balance

What you have across everything, right now. Money you have put into a savings goal stays inside this figure but is also reported separately as earmarked, so you can see both the real number and the part already promised.

### When money gets tight

A month can end comfortably and still have a week in the middle where rent, an EMI and a card bill land together before your salary arrives. The app walks your balance forward one day at a time and tells you the date things get uncomfortable — which is far more useful than a month-end figure that hides it.

### Things worth mentioning

The app notices patterns in your own records and remarks on them: a category well above its usual level, a loan about to finish, a card creeping towards its limit. Each one states the figures behind it. They stay quiet until there is enough history to justify them, because a confident claim from two weeks of data is noise.

### Coming up

The next fortnight of dated commitments, in order. Anything here is something you have already told the app about.

## 4. Recording spending

Three ways in, and only two fields are ever required.

### By hand

Tap the + button on the dashboard. An amount and a category are all you need; everything else is optional so a routine entry takes seconds.

|                           |                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Paid by</b>            | Cash, UPI, card and so on. Choosing Credit card is what tells the app not to reduce your bank balance today. |
| <b>Paid from</b>          | Which account the money left. Optional — but filling it in is what makes per-account balances work.          |
| <b>Spent on / Vehicle</b> | Tie an expense to a family member or a vehicle to see what each one costs you.                               |
| <b>Person</b>             | For money you spent on someone else's behalf.                                                                |

### By voice

Tap the microphone and say something ordinary like “spent 500 on lunch by UPI”. The app fills the form and hands it back for you to check. It never saves from speech alone — recognition mishears numbers, and a wrong amount written straight into your records is worse than no entry at all.

### From a bank SMS

**More** → **Import from SMS** reads your bank alerts and turns them into entries. Nothing is imported without you ticking it. Anything that looks like something you already typed arrives unticked and flagged, because a duplicate quietly makes your balance wrong while a missing entry is at least visible.

#### Would rather not grant SMS access?

The same screen lets you paste a single message instead. That path needs no permission at all.

## 5. Money coming in

The app keeps the *rule* and the *money* apart, which is what lets it say “salary is expected on the 1st” and “it has not arrived yet” at the same time.

### Income sources

A source is the schedule: how much, which day, how often. Add a yearly increment and the forecast applies the raise on each anniversary of the start date, so a salary that began in April rises in April rather than in January.

### Receipts

A receipt is money that actually arrived. Mark a salary as received and the forecast stops expecting it for that month.

**Paid early?**

A salary due on the 1st but credited on the 31st of the month before is recorded against the month it was *for*, not the month it landed in. Without that, the app would keep expecting a payment you had already been given.

## 6. Accounts

The dashboard tells you how much you have. Accounts tell you where it is — which is the question that decides whether a payment will actually go through on Tuesday.

### Adding an account

**More** → **Accounts** → **+**. Give it a name, pick a type (bank, cash or wallet), and enter the balance it held on an opening date. Everything recorded from that date onwards is applied to that starting figure, so the balance always explains itself.

### What each card shows

|                    |                                                             |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Balance</b>     | What the account holds today.                               |
| <b>Opened with</b> | The starting figure you entered.                            |
| <b>In / Out</b>    | Everything that has arrived in and left this account since. |

### Moving money between accounts

Use the **Move money** button in the top bar. A transfer is neither income nor an expense — nothing was earned or spent, the same rupees simply sit somewhere else. Your total does not change; only where it sits does. Recording it as a payment instead would inflate both your monthly income and your monthly spending.

**“Not linked to any account”**

If some of your money cannot be placed in a specific account, the app says so rather than quietly attributing it to the first one. It means those entries were recorded without choosing an account. Your total is still correct — this only says the app does not know which account holds it. Fill in **Paid from** on future entries and the gap stops growing.

### Closing an account

Closing hides an account from new entries but keeps everything already recorded against it. A closed bank account is still where last year's rent actually went, so that history is never thrown away.

## 7. Commitments

Everything you are already on the hook for. Each one is a schedule the forecast reads, so you never have to remember what is due.

## EMIs and loans

Enter the installment, the tenure and the first due date. If the loan is already running, say how many installments you have paid and the remaining tenure works itself out — the app derives it from your records rather than storing a counter that can go stale.

Add the interest rate and the app can also show what paying extra would buy you. The answer is usually far larger than people expect, because money paid early reduces the balance interest is charged on for every remaining month. Without a rate it says it cannot model it, rather than inventing one.

## Recurring bills

Rent, electricity, school fees, subscriptions. A bill can be a fixed amount or an estimate — mark a variable one as estimated and the forecast shows a realistic figure while making clear it is not fixed. Mark it paid at the amount actually billed.

## Yearly expenses

Insurance, property tax, and the other payments that quietly break a monthly budget. The app forecasts them in the month they fall due *and* shows the monthly amount worth setting aside so they do not arrive as a shock.

## Credit cards

Record your outstanding and the due day from your statement. The card bill is what the forecast projects, not individual purchases. When you pay the bill, the app reduces the outstanding and takes the cash out of your balance in one step — no separate expense, which would subtract it twice.

### Undoing a payment

Marking something paid by mistake is easy to undo. Only that one period is reversed — undoing September's rent leaves every other month exactly as it was.

# 8. People and shared bills

Who owes you, whom you owe, and what happens when a bill is split.

## Simple balances

Record what you lent or borrowed, optionally with a date you expect it back. Balances are always recomputed from the entries and the settlements beneath them, so a total can never drift away from the history that is supposed to explain it.

## Part payments

Settlements are applied oldest first, so you can see which specific loans are cleared rather than only a single net figure. Money received beyond what was owed is surfaced rather than absorbed, because an unexplained extra payment is usually a mistake worth noticing.

## Splitting a bill

Choose the people, pick how to split — equally, by exact amounts, by percentage, or one person pays all — and the shares always add back to the total to the paisa.

- **If you paid:** the full amount leaves your balance, and everyone else's share becomes money owed to you.
- **If someone else paid:** only your own share becomes a balance. What the others owe them is between them, and is not your ledger to carry.

## 9. Budgets

Set a monthly limit per category, or one overall limit across everything.

Budgets count differently from the forecast, and the difference is deliberate. The forecast tracks *cash*, so a card purchase is not counted until the bill is paid. A budget tracks *spending*, so a card purchase counts the day you make it. A limit on groceries means the groceries, however you paid for them.

### The useful part is the pace

Knowing you have spent 60% of the food budget is half the story. Knowing that at this rate you will finish the month 20% over is what actually changes anything.

## 10. Goals and the emergency fund

A goal is a target amount, optionally with a date. The app works out what it needs each month to stay on track, and shows progress from the contributions beneath it — so the bar can never disagree with its own history.

Money put into a goal is set aside, not spent. It stays in your balance and is reported separately as earmarked.

### The emergency fund

This one is calculated rather than guessed. The app works out what one month of essential living actually costs you from three separate places, each counted once:

- bills you have marked essential, from their own schedules;
- loan installments, because a lender does not pause during a bad month;
- everyday spending in essential categories, from your actual history;
- plus the monthly share of your yearly commitments.

Multiply by how many months of cover you want and that is the target. It also tells you how many months your fund would actually last today, which is usually the more useful number than a percentage.

## 11. Looking ahead

### The forecast

Month by month, starting with this one. Each month opens with the closing balance of the month before, so a shortfall is carried forward rather than quietly reset. The current month only projects what is *left* to happen, because what you have already spent is inside your balance.

### The calendar



Every dated commitment on the day it falls. Useful for planning a large purchase around the days money is already spoken for.

## Can I afford it?

Enter an amount and a horizon. The app reports the arithmetic and leaves the decision with you. It pays particular attention to the *lowest* point your balance is projected to reach, because a comfortable final month can easily hide an empty one in between.

|                        |                                                                   |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Safe</b>            | It fits comfortably alongside your upcoming payments.             |
| <b>Be careful</b>      | You can do it, but it leaves little room for anything unexpected. |
| <b>Not recommended</b> | It would put your upcoming payments under pressure.               |

If it is tight, the app also says roughly how long waiting would help — but only when there is a projected surplus to build on.

## Ask a question

The assistant answers questions about your own money in plain language: “how much can I spend”, “who owes me”, “what is due this month”. It is a rules engine, not a chatbot — it runs on the device, it is instant, and it cannot invent a number that is not in your data. When it does not understand, it says so and offers what it can answer.

# 12. Reports and exports

Reports break a month down by category, largest first, with what came in against what went out. Spending per family member and per vehicle is available from their own screens.

**Settings** → **Export** writes your expenses as a CSV that opens directly in Excel or Google Sheets.

# 13. Backup and restore

Your records exist in one place: this phone. Backups are the only thing standing between a lost phone and lost history, so they are worth setting up on day one.

## Manual backup

**Settings** → **Back up now** writes a single file containing everything, and hands it to the system share sheet. You choose where it goes — the app never sends it anywhere itself.

## Automatic backup

Pick a folder once and the app writes a fresh backup there every week, keeping the most recent few and removing older ones. Picking the folder is what grants access to it; the app never asks for storage permission.

## Restoring

**Settings** → **Restore** and choose a backup file. Restoring replaces everything currently in the app. If anything goes wrong part-way through, nothing is changed at all — it is all or nothing, never half-restored.

**Older backups still work**

A backup written by an earlier version of the app restores fine. Anything the older file did not know about simply comes back empty, which is exactly the state it was in when the file was written.

## 14. Privacy and the app lock

### What leaves your phone

Nothing. The app has no internet permission at all, so it could not transmit your records even if it tried. There are no accounts, no sync and no analytics.

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bank SMS</b>     | Read on the device, parsed, and thrown away. Only what you tick is saved. Only messages from bank shortcodes are looked at — never from ordinary phone numbers, so personal conversations are not touched. |
| <b>Backups</b>      | Written locally and handed to you. Where they go afterwards is your choice.                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Cloud backup</b> | Your financial data is explicitly excluded from Android's own cloud and device-transfer backups.                                                                                                           |

### The app lock

Set a PIN in **Settings** → **Security**, and add fingerprint unlock if your phone supports it. Your PIN itself is never stored — only a slow, salted hash of it, so reading the app's files does not reveal it.

The lock re-arms whenever the app leaves the foreground, so coming back to it asks again. After several wrong attempts the input pauses for a short while, and that pause survives restarting the app.

## 15. Starting again

Two different things, kept apart on purpose so neither happens by accident. Both are in **Settings** → **Start again**, both offer to save a backup first, and both ask you to type a word to confirm.

|                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Clear all my records</b>     | Deletes every expense, income, loan, bill, person, goal and account movement, then puts the default categories and one account back so you can start recording immediately. Your PIN, theme and reminders are left alone. |
| <b>Reset the app completely</b> | Everything above, plus your PIN, theme, reminders and backup folder. The app returns to how it was the day you installed it, and setup runs again.                                                                        |

**There is no undo**

A reset is the one action in the app with nothing behind it — your records cannot be rebuilt from anywhere else. Take the backup when it is offered, even if you are sure.

*Your money, on your phone, explained by the records you put in.*